

TOPIC 1: THE ANNUNCIATION

1. Meaning of the Annunciation

The Annunciation is the announcement by the angel Gabriel to the Virgin Mary that she would conceive and give birth to Jesus, the Son of God. It is recorded especially in Luke 1:26–38 and linked with prophecies such as Isaiah 9:6–7 and Matthew 1:22–23.

2. Biblical References

- Isaiah 9:6–7 – Prophecy of a child to be born who will be called Wonderful Counsellor, Mighty God, Everlasting Father, Prince of Peace; His government will have no end.
- Matthew 1:22–23 – Fulfilment of Isaiah's prophecy: the virgin shall conceive and bear a son, and they shall call His name Immanuel (God with us).
- Luke 1:30–33 – Angel Gabriel tells Mary not to be afraid; she will conceive and bear a son named Jesus; He will be great, called the Son of the Most High, and will reign on David's throne forever.

3. Key Lessons

- God keeps His promises (Old Testament prophecy fulfilled).
- Mary's faith and obedience: "Let it be to me according to your word."
- Jesus is both human (born of Mary) and divine (Son of God).
- God chooses ordinary people for extraordinary purposes.

4. Summary

The Annunciation is God's announcement of the birth of Jesus through Mary. It fulfils prophecy and shows Mary's humble acceptance of God's will.

End of Topic 1